

We Were Almost Entirely Wrong About China

中國

20:38 ✈️ 文化體驗

☒ 全文閱讀

點選段落標題展開內容，點選其他段落自動收起

1. We Were Almost Entirely Wrong About China

BZ Travel English Study | video_id: AOEr5FrW-IY | 20:38 | 135,647 views

我們對中國有一套理論。我們讀過一些東西、看過新聞、也和去過那裡的人聊過。我們以為自己對即將面對的情況有合理的認識。我們錯了——不是小錯，而是幾乎全錯。這是一個關於我們在中國境內旅行22天的系列影片的第一集。我們以私人方式旅行，只有我們兩個人，每個城市都有不同的當地導遊陪同。沒有旅遊巴士，沒有團體行程，只有我們穿梭在這顆星球上最非凡的國度之一，盡全力去理解它。我們會帶你去看風景、品美食、看那些你來中國想看的一切。但我們也想試著解釋更難的東西——這個國家到底是什麼樣子、它如何思考、它經歷過什麼、為什麼走到了今天這一步。因為如果你只看漂亮的畫面，你就會錯過整個故事。我叫Tresa。你在螢幕上一直看到的那個探索一切、坐在每輛車裡的男人，是我的丈夫Zarko。我們一起經營這個頻道，一起在中國私人旅行了22天。我們帶回來的問題比答案多——說實話，這是一趟旅行最好的結果。我是美國人，在美國出生長大。這意味著我對世界有一套相當特定的認識：共產主義是敵人，蘇聯陣營是灰暗而可怕的，而中國則是個遙遠而神祕的地方，只有在出問題的時候才會聽說它。Zarko的故事不一樣。他在保加利亞的共產主義制度下長大——不是讀到而已，而是親身經歷。一黨專政、國家控制一切。你必須低調行事，不能問不該問的問題。他在25歲時以政治難民身份離開，後來在西雅圖創辦了一家養活125個家庭的企業。我們退休後搬回了保加利亞，住在黑海邊的布爾加斯。那是七年前的事了。我告訴你這些，是因為這對你即將看到的一切都很重要。當我看著中國時，我帶著一個美國人的眼光——

2. Introduction

We had a theory about China. We had read things, watched the news, talked to people who had been there. We thought we had a reasonable picture of what to expect. We were wrong. Not a little wrong — almost entirely wrong. This is the first video in a series about 22 days inside China. We traveled privately, just the two of us, with a different local guide in each city. No tour buses, no group schedules, just us moving through one of the most extraordinary countries on Earth trying our best to understand it. My name is Tresa. That guy you keep seeing on screen exploring everything, sitting in every car — that's my husband, Zarko. Together, we run this channel, and together we spent 22 days traveling China privately. We came back with more questions than answers, which honestly is the best possible outcome from any trip.

伊斯坦堡已經成為世界上最大的旅行樞紐之一，幾乎可以連接任何地方。商務艙的價格僅是歐洲航空公司的幾分之一。在十小時的飛行中，商務艙不再是一種奢侈品，而是一種自我保護。我們在清晨抵達上海浦東。作為對中國的第一個體驗，我們決定搭乘磁浮列車進城——磁力懸浮，軌道上沒有輪子，最高時速430公里。這是抵達這座城市最恰當的方式。老實說，這項技術已經有20年了。它其實是德國技術，在德國發明，在這裡建造，然後在全球大部分地區被放棄，因為它太昂貴、太缺乏彈性、難以規模化。列車在平日上午幾乎空無一人，內部裝潢感覺有點過時，我們實際達到的最高時速約為300公里——這聽起來很厲害，直到你發現中國的常規高鐵現在在全國範圍內都能達到類似的速度。我們幾天後第一次搭乘高鐵時就會親身體驗到。我們的酒店就在南京路上——不是靠近它，而是在它上面。我們拉開窗簾，它就在我們正下方——上海最著名的商業街道，從外灘一直延伸到城市的心臟。它從不停歇，日夜不分。我們睡了幾個小時。與保加利亞七小時的時差可不客氣。然後我們就出門散步了。這就是那個時刻——我曾聽其他旅行者說起過但不太相信的那個時刻——當你的預期和你實際上站立其中的現實靜靜地分道揚鑣的時候。街道一塵不染。建築令人嘆為觀止。所有你聽說過的奢侈品牌都在這裡，還有我從未見過的中國品牌。人們穿著得體，步調從容，過著自己的生活。一切都帶著一種我只能形容為「有條不紊」的高效節奏運轉。人們把夜晚的南京路比作——

3. Who We Are

I'm American, born and raised in the US, which means I grew up with a pretty specific picture of the world. Communism was the enemy. The Soviet bloc was gray and scary. And China was this distant, mysterious place you only heard about when something went wrong. Zarko's story is different. He grew up in Bulgaria under communism — not reading about it, living it. One party, state control over everything. You kept your head down and you did not ask the wrong questions. He left at 25 as a political refugee, built a business in Seattle that supported 125 families. And when we retired, we moved back to Bulgaria, to Burgas on the Black Sea. That was 7 years ago. I'm telling you all of this because it matters for everything you're about to see. When I look at China, I'm looking through American eyes. When Zarko looks at China, he's looking through the eyes of someone who actually lived inside a communist system. Our questions are completely different. And when we compare notes at the end of the day, neither one of us has the full picture alone, but together we get a little closer to something real. That's what this series is about.

被徹底禁止，被視為國家安全風險。在歐洲，這項爭論仍在持續。然後你走進它們在上海的旗艦店，立刻就明白為什麼它們讓各國政府感到不安。這不是一家手機公司。華為是一整個生態系統——智慧型手機、平板電腦、筆記型電腦、智慧手錶、家庭自動化設備，還有汽車。純電動車，多種型號，美輪美奐。Zarko在那個展廳裡走動的樣子就像聖誕節前一週的小孩，他每一輛都坐過了——ST9、Z7、M9，每一輛。真正讓我們倆都停下來的是——一台叫做Matebook Fold的筆記型電腦。它像普通筆電一樣打開，然後螢幕展開成一個全尺寸顯示

器——介於平板電腦和工作站之間的一體機。這項工程技術確實令人驚嘆。Zarko在那張桌子前站了很久。然後是小米專賣店。小米什麼都做——手機、電視、電鍋、滑板車、掃地機器人，還有一輛車。小米SU7是一款電動轎車，讓歐美汽車製造商暗自緊張。它比大多數競爭對手更好看，而且價格低得多。然後是大疆創新。你現在看到的一切都是用大疆Osmo Pocket 4拍攝的——Zarko為這個頻道選擇的相機。走進大疆旗艦店的感覺有點像朝聖。那天早上從一家店走到另一家店，有件事一直困擾著我：這不是憑空出現的創新。中國每年培養的工程師比世界上任何國家都多。政府將人工智慧、電動車和先進製造業定為國家優先事項，然後持續投入數十年。不管你對這些決策背後的政治體制怎麼看，產出就在你面前，而且它確實有效。這輛混合動力車可以跑1000公里。我們在上海看到的最了不起的事情之一不是地標建築，也不是科技展廳——

4. Getting There

Istanbul has become one of the great travel hubs in the world, connected to almost everywhere, with business class fares that are a fraction of what you'd pay on a European carrier. On a 10-hour flight, business class stops being a luxury. It becomes self-preservation. We landed early morning at Shanghai Pudong. And for our very first experience of China, we decided to take the Maglev into the city. Magnetic levitation — no wheels on the track, top speed of 430 km/h. It felt like exactly the right way to arrive. Honest review: it's 20 years old. The technology is actually German, invented in Germany, built here, then largely abandoned worldwide because it was too expensive and too inflexible to scale. The train was nearly empty on a weekday morning. The interior felt dated, and the top speed we actually hit was around 300 km/h — which sounds impressive until you learn that China's regular high-speed trains now reach similar speeds across the entire country.

一架無人機出現在那裡——一架真正的無人機從建築物上方降下來，下面掛著一個餐袋，精準地降落在標記好的投放區。食物來自附近一座購物中心屋頂上的餐廳。從有人下單到無人機落地，總共12分鐘。我們的導遊告訴我們，她的母親——一位獨居的老太太——幾乎所有的東西都是用這種方式送達的：雜貨、餐點、日用品。她在微信上下單，用微信付款，東西就送到家門口。她再也不需要提重物或在擁擠的市場裡擠來擠去。我覺得這個故事真的很打動人。從那一刻起，我開始明白為什麼在中國每個人都盯著手機看。那不是無意識的滑動。他們的手機不是生活的干擾物——而是運行生活的系統。而在中國，它運行得非常好。我們還去了比亞迪的展廳——Build Your Dreams。它是現在全球銷量最大的電動車製造商，比特斯拉還大，比福斯還大。在中國，電動車不是一種趨勢或未來的預覽——它們就是汽車本來的樣子。我們去的一個購物中心，一樓就有汽車經銷商——在購物中心裡面，不是在停車場，而是在餐廳和服裝店之間。你可以買一輛電動車，然後上兩層樓去吃晚飯。這與附近特斯拉展廳的對比難以忽視。華為有八九個型號擺滿了整個樓層，蔚來也差不多——多種型號、Lounge氛圍、真心想為你詳細介紹的銷售人員。特斯拉只有兩輛車。相比之下顯

得空空蕩蕩。在上海的最後一個早晨，我們的導遊做了一件我們意想不到的事。她沒有帶我們去另一個地標或另一個展廳，而是帶我們去了公園。當時大概清晨，公園裡已經滿了——不是像旅遊景點那樣滿，而是滿了屬於那裡的人。退休的——

5. Shanghai: First Impressions

Our hotel was right on Nanjing Road — not near it, on it. We opened the curtains and there it was, directly below us. The most famous commercial street in Shanghai, running from the Bund straight through the heart of the city. It never stops, day or night. This is the moment other travelers talk about but you haven't quite believed: when what you expected and what you're actually standing inside quietly come apart. The streets are spotless. The architecture is extraordinary. Every luxury brand you've ever heard of is here alongside Chinese brands I'd never encountered. People are well-dressed, unhurried, going about their lives. Everything moves with a purposeful efficiency I can only describe as organized. People compare Nanjing Road at night to Time Square. I've been to Times Square. Times Square is loud and chaotic in a way that feels almost accidental. Nanjing Road feels deliberate, like someone asked what a great city street should actually look like and then built the answer. There's a robot that makes coffee right there on the street.

之後我一直想起他說的話。他說：「這就是退休生活應該有的樣子。」我無話可說。在上海那最初幾天之後，有一個問題一直縈繞心頭。我們走過南京路、站在外灘、看著無人機在12分鐘內送來午餐、清晨在公園裡和陌生人一起跳舞——這一切是怎麼發生的？這是我事先知道的：1950年，中國是地球上最貧窮的國家之一。這裡的人均收入低於撒哈拉以南非洲的人均水平。一個世紀的戰爭、侵略、饑荒和政治動盪將這個國家撕裂——大多數村莊沒有電、沒有鋪設道路、沒有真正的工業。然後情況變得更加糟糕。1958年，毛澤東發動了他所謂的「大躍進」，目標是將中國轉變為現代工業強國。15年內，私人農業被廢除。人民家裡沒有東西可吃。隨後的饑荒導致1500萬到4500萬人死亡。這就是存在於人們記憶中的中國。我們這趟旅行遇到的許多老年人——導遊、酒店員工、看起來和我們差不多年紀的人——都出生在那個世界，或者他們的父母是。真實的、飢腸轆轆的饑荒在這裡不是遙遠的歷史——它只隔了一代人。然後在1978年，情況發生了變化。毛澤東兩年前去世了。一個叫鄧小平的人掌握了權力。鄧小平看著過去30年的廢墟，做出了一個簡單到令人矚目的決定：「不管黑貓白貓，能捉老鼠的就是好貓。」他向外國投資開放了中國，允許私營企業與國營企業並存，創建了明確允許市場資本主義的經濟特區——只是為了測試它，看看會發生什麼。他派遣中國學生到西方大學留學。他獎勵成果。他讓共產黨繼續掌握政治權力——

6. Technology: Huawei, Xiaomi, DJI, BYD

We walked into the Huawei flagship store in Shanghai and immediately understood why they make governments nervous. This is not a phone company. Huawei is an entire ecosystem — smartphones, tablets, laptops, smartwatches, home automation, and cars. Full electric vehicles, multiple models. Zarko moved through that showroom like a kid the week before Christmas. What stopped us both was a laptop called the Matebook Fold: it opens like a normal laptop, then the screen unfolds into a full-size display — something between a tablet and a workstation in a single piece of hardware. Then the Xiaomi store. Xiaomi makes everything — phones, TVs, rice cookers, scooters, robot vacuums, and a car. The Xiaomi SU7 is an electric sedan that's been making European and American automakers quietly nervous. It looks better than most of what it competes with and costs considerably less. The DJI store. Everything you're watching right now was filmed on a DJI Osmo Pocket 4, Zarko's camera of choice. Walking store to store that morning, something kept pulling at me. China graduates more engineers every year than any other country on Earth. The government identified AI, electric vehicles, and advanced manufacturing as national priorities and then sustained that investment for decades. Whatever you think of the political system behind those decisions, the output is sitting right in front of you and it works.

(翻譯待更新)

7. The Supermarket & Drone Delivery

One of the most remarkable things we saw in Shanghai wasn't a landmark or a tech showroom. It was a supermarket. Hema, owned by Alibaba, looks like an upscale grocery at first — seafood tanks where you point at your fish and they prepare it for you, beautiful produce, a hot food section. But look up. Running above the entire store is a conveyor belt — a whole network of ceiling tracks with bags hanging from them, moving in every direction. A silent river of orders flowing overhead while people shop below. Hema isn't just a supermarket. It's a fulfillment center that also lets people shop in person. And then a drone arrived. An actual drone descending from above the buildings with a food bag hanging underneath it, landing precisely on a marked drop zone. The food came from a restaurant on the rooftop of a nearby mall. From the moment someone placed the order to the moment the drone landed: 12 minutes. Our guide told us her mother — an elderly woman living alone — gets almost everything delivered this way: groceries, meals, household items. She orders on WeChat, pays on WeChat, and it arrives at her door. I found that genuinely moving. And that's when I started to understand why everyone in China is

on their phone. It isn't mindless scrolling. Their phone isn't a distraction from their life. It is the system that runs their life. And in China, it runs it remarkably well.

(翻譯待更新)

8. Electric Vehicles

We also spent time in the BYD showroom — Build Your Dreams, now the largest electric vehicle manufacturer in the world by sales. Bigger than Tesla. Bigger than Volkswagen. In China, electric vehicles aren't a trend or a glimpse of the future. They're just what cars are. One of the malls we visited had car dealerships on the ground floor. Inside the shopping mall, not in the parking lot — between the restaurant and the clothing store. The contrast with the Tesla showroom nearby was hard to ignore. Huawei had eight or nine models filling the floor. NIO was similar — multiple models, lounge atmosphere. Tesla had two cars. It felt sparse by comparison.

(翻譯待更新)

9. Morning in the Park

On our last morning in Shanghai, our guide took us to a park. It was early, maybe 7 a.m., and the park was full — not full like a tourist site, full of people who belong there. Retired people mostly, spread across the whole space in different groups, each doing something completely different. Tai Chi in one corner. A ballroom dancing group nearby — 20 people partner dancing on the paving stones to music from a small speaker on a bench. Further along, a group of musicians playing traditional instruments together. And then further still, a group just singing, like they did this every single morning. Zarko said something afterwards that I keep coming back to. He said: "This is what retirement should look like." I couldn't argue with him.

(翻譯待更新)

10. China's Economic History

After those first few days in Shanghai, one question kept coming back. How did this happen? In 1950, China was one of the poorest countries on Earth. A century of war, invasion, famine, and political upheaval had torn the country apart. And then it got

worse. In 1958, Mao Zhaog launched what he called the Great Leap Forward. Private farming was abolished. Between 15 and 45 million people died in the famine that followed. This is the China that existed within living memory. Many of the older people we met on this trip were born into that world, or their parents were. Then in 1978, something changed. Mao had died two years earlier. A man named Deng Xiaoping took power. And Deng looked at the wreckage of the previous 30 years and made a decision that was remarkable for how simple it was. Whatever works, he said. If a cat catches mice, it doesn't matter if it's black or white. He opened China to foreign investment, allowed private business alongside the state, created special economic zones. He sent Chinese students abroad to study in western universities. He kept the Communist Party in political control — but onto all of that he grafted a form of capitalism so aggressive and competitive it makes most western economies look cautious. The result: China today is not communist in any way Marx would recognize. It's something with no clean name. A one-party political structure running on top of an extraordinarily dynamic market economy.

(翻譯待更新)

☒精選字彙 20 字

從文章中挑選的核心單字

- 1theory/'θiri/ (名) 理論；說法
- 2reasonable/'rizənəbəl/ (形) 合理的
- 3extraordinary/ɪk'strɔːrdə,nəri/ (形) 非凡的
- 4security/sə'kjʊərəti/ (名) 安全；保全
- 5flagship/'flæg,ʃɪp/ (名) 旗艦店
- 6drone/droʊn/ (名) 無人機
- 7precisely/prɪ'saɪsli/ (副) 精確地
- 8infrastructure/'ɪnfərə,striktʃər/ (名) 基礎建設
- 9revolution/,revə'lʊʃən/ (名) 革命
- 10autonomous/ɔː'tanəməs/ (形) 自動的；自主的
- 11dominate/'dɒmə,net/ (動) 主導；支配
- 12commute/kə'mjʊt/ (名/動) 通勤
- 13retirement/rɪ'taɪərmənt/ (名) 退休
- 14pension/'penʃən/ (名) 退休金；養老金
- 15unexpected/,ʌnɪk'spektɪd/ (形) 出乎意料的
- 16genuine/'dʒenjuɪn/ (形) 真誠的；真正的
- 17perspective/pər'spektɪv/ (名) 觀點；視角
- 18contradiction/,kɒntrə'dɪkʃən/ (名) 矛盾
- 19prosperity/prə'sperəti/ (名) 繁榮
- 20unfiltered/ʌn'fɪltəd/ (形) 未過濾的；真實的

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- 20unfiltered/ʌn'fɪltəd/ (形) 未過濾的；真實的

id="section-collocations" class="section">

☒實用搭配詞 8 組

點選搭配詞展開完整內容

1. build assumptions

建立假設；形成先入為主的看法

文中例句

"We had built assumptions about China from news reports."

Before visiting a new country, it's easy to _____ from what you read online.

2. crumble

崩潰；瓦解

文中例句

"Our assumptions began to crumble the moment we arrived."

When I saw the real city, all my preconceptions started to _____.

3. keep your head down

低調行事；不引人注目

文中例句

"Under communism, you kept your head down and did not ask the wrong questions."

In a strict environment, it's often safer to _____ and follow the rules.

4. political refugee

政治難民

文中例句

"He left Bulgaria at 25 as a political refugee."

Many people flee their home country as a _____ due to persecution.

5. reasonable picture

合理的認識；合理的畫面

文中例句

"We thought we had a reasonable picture of what to expect."

After reading the guidebook, I felt I had a _____ of the city.

6. more questions than answers

問題多於答案

文中例句

"We came back with more questions than answers."

The documentary left me with _____ about the political situation.

7. state control

國家控制

文中例句

"Zarko lived under one party and state control over everything."

Under _____, the government decides what businesses can produce.

8. miss the whole story

錯過整個故事；未能理解全貌

文中例句

"If you only watch the pretty pictures, you will miss the whole story."

If you judge a country only by its tourist attractions, you _____.

☒ 文法重點 2 點

點選文法點展開說明

Past Perfect Tense for Background Information

過去完成式用於描述在另一個過去事件之前已經發生的情況。在本影片中，「We had read things, watched the news... We thought we had a reasonable picture」使用過去完成式來強調在抵達中國之前就已經形成的認知。

We had a theory about China. We had read things, watched the news, talked to people who had been there.

had read, had watched, had talked — 這些過去完成式動詞描述在他們實際訪問中國之前所做的事情。主句使用簡單過去式 (had a theory)，而從句使用過去完成式來表示更早發生的動作。

Subject + had + past participle + (object), before + subject + simple past...

He grew up in Bulgaria under communism. Not reading about it, living it.

使用簡單過去式 (grew up) 敘述過去的事實。然後用現在分詞 (reading, living) 進行對比，強調親身經歷與間接了解的差異。

Subject + simple past + ... Not + verb-ing + (about) + object, verb-ing + object

將以下句子改寫為過去完成式：'I read about the country before I visited it.'

Comparative Structures for Contrast

比較結構用於對比兩個人物、觀點或經歷。影片中頻繁使用比較來凸顯Tresa和Zarko之間不同的背景和視角。

Zarko's story is different. He grew up in Bulgaria under communism.

使用 'is different' 引入對比。然後詳細解釋Zarko的經歷如何與Tresa的經歷形成對比。這是一種常見的篇章組織方式。

A's story/narrative/experience is different. A + verb + (details of difference)...

I'm American... which means I grew up with a pretty specific picture of the world.

使用 'which means' 引入解釋或結果。這裡用來解釋Tresa的成長背景如何塑造了她的世界觀。

Subject + be + nationality/identity, which means + subject + grew up with + noun phrase

完成句子：'My experience was different from my friend's. I grew up in a small town, which means _____.'

☒ 關鍵句型 4 組

點選句型展開範例與練習

We thought we had a [adjective] picture of [noun]

我們以為自己對某事有某種認識

We thought we had a reasonable picture of what to expect.

We thought we had a [clear/reasonable/accurate] picture of [the situation/the country/what was coming].

用這個句型造句，描述一次你對某事的預期與實際不符的經驗。

Not [adverb] wrong, [adverb] wrong

不是某種程度的錯誤，而是另一種程度的錯誤

We were wrong. Not a little wrong, almost entirely wrong.

Not [a little/slightly/partially] wrong, [completely/totally/almost entirely] wrong.

用這個句型強調一次重大的誤判。

We came back with more [noun] than [noun]

我們帶回了比某物更多的某物

We came back with more questions than answers.

[Subject] came back with more [questions/doubts/problems] than [answers/solutions/results].

用這個句型描述一次發人深省的旅行經歷。

If you only [verb], you will miss [noun]

如果你只做某事，你會錯過某事

If you only watch the pretty pictures, you will miss the whole story.

If you only [focus on / look at / pay attention to] [superficial aspect], you will miss [deeper meaning / the real point].

用這個句型說明為什麼只看表面是不夠的。

☒ 閱讀測驗 5 題

點選答案即時對答

☒ 來源：[BZ Travel](#)

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